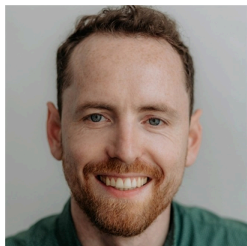


Dr. John D. Kirwan

Computational Biologist · Bioinformatics & Machine Learning · Biostatistics

La Laguna, Spain • john@jkirwan.org • +34 639981732 • jkirwan.org



PROFILE

Computational biologist and data scientist pairing rigorous statistical modelling — Bayesian inference and deep learning — with hands-on ML engineering and reproducible pipelines. Nearly four years at the interface of biotech and AI in an industry research setting, spanning biomolecular structure prediction, generative molecular design, and metagenomic analysis, and including a contribution to a NeurIPS 2025 publication on uncertainty quantification.

KEY SKILLS

Python R

PyTorch

Machine Learning

Deep Learning

Bayesian Statistics

Protein Structure
Prediction

Structural
Bioinformatics

Metagenomics

Docker

PROFILES

JohnKirwan

johndkirwan

0000-0001-5537-3574

johnkirwan

LANGUAGES

English (Native)

Spanish (B2)

Swedish (B2)

SELECTED HIGHLIGHTS

- Drug-discovery ML: structure prediction, docking and binding-affinity modelling in industry R&D
- Bayesian multilevel modelling (R, Stan) underpinning peer-reviewed work in quantitative biology
- Open-source R packages with browser-based Shiny apps: radiatR and luxR

RECENT EXPERIENCE

Bioinformatics Scientist *Arquimea Research Centre, La Laguna, Spain* (Jul 2022-Mar 2026)

Worked at the interface of the AI and biotech teams on structure-based drug discovery, generative molecular design, and applied machine learning — the link between the computational tools and the biology.

- Contributing author on a NeurIPS 2025 paper on uncertainty quantification for deep regression: ran the empirical validation and fine-tuned/retrained models in PyTorch
- Built a modular synthetic-data-generation pipeline orchestrating GNINA, DiffDock and AlphaFold 2, including dataset sourcing and inter-tool format conversion
- Predicted protein structures and binding affinities for protein complexes, including metal-ion and ATP cofactors, using Boltz, AlphaFold, Foldseek and BioEMU
- Developed the binding-affinity objective for Uncharted, an internal venture building a multi-objective small-molecule optimisation engine
- Analysed metagenomic data, prototyped a novel operon-design approach, and ran statistical power analyses for preclinical study design
- Ran GPU workloads on an NVIDIA DGX cluster and AWS; Docker, Git and Azure DevOps within an Agile/Scrum team

Postdoctoral Researcher *Stazione Zoologica Anton Dohrn, Naples, Italy* (Oct 2019-Jul 2022)

Quantitative sensory biology within an international Human Frontier Science Program (HFSP) collaboration, with emphasis on statistical modelling and signal processing of behavioural data.

- Analysed experimental data using Bayesian multilevel regression models in R and Stan
- Designed and executed behavioural experiments with automated data acquisition pipelines
- Contributed to interdisciplinary publications spanning biology, optics, and computation

EDUCATION

PhD Sensory Biology *Lund University, Sweden* (May 2013-May 2018) Thesis: 'Spatial Vision in Diverse Invertebrates'.

MSc Molecular Evolution *University College Dublin, Ireland* (Dec 2008-Jun 2010) Thesis: 'The Molecular Evolution of Hearing in Mammals'

BSc (Hons) Zoology *University College Dublin, Ireland* (Sep 2004-May 2008)

- First Class Honours (GPA: 4.02/4.2)

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Project Manager (contract) *Lund University, Lund, Sweden* (Jun 2019-Aug 2019) Short-term research management contract supervising experimental data collection and a masters student, bridging doctoral and postdoctoral positions.

Doctoral Researcher *Lund University, Lund, Sweden* (May 2013-Jun 2018) Computational and statistical analysis of visual systems in invertebrates, combining experimental biology with quantitative modelling.

- Built statistical models using Bayesian multilevel regression in R and Stan; additional analysis in Python and Matlab
- Developed optical and geometric models to estimate spatial resolution theoretically
- Designed novel experimental protocols for quantifying animal visual performance

OPEN-SOURCE SOFTWARE

- **radiatR** — R package and Shiny app for circular-arena tracking data; imports from 20+ tracking tools, circular statistics and figures
- **luxR** — R package and Shiny app for modelling underwater light environments, photoreceptor excitation and visual contrast

AWARDS & CERTIFICATIONS

- Pharmaceutical Bioinformatics & Applied Pharmaceutical Bioinformatics — Uppsala University — 2020 Pass with Distinction
- Customising your models with TensorFlow 2 — Coursera / Imperial College London — 2025
- Valohai MLOps Fundamentals Certification — Valohai — 2025
- Applied Software Engineering Fundamentals Specialization — Coursera / IBM — 2023 Covers Git, GitHub, Linux, and Python, and the fundamentals of software engineering.
- Mountain Leader Award — Mountain Leader Training Scotland — 2011 Professional certification to lead hillwalking groups.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

Uncertainty Quantification for Deep Regression using Contextualised Normalizing Flows Adriel Sosa Marco, John D. Kirwan, Alexia Toumpa, Simos Gerasimou *The Thirty-ninth Annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems, 2025* doi.org/10.52202/085713-1692

Phenotypic response to food availability in sea urchin larvae and impact of light during development and growth Maria Cocurullo, John D. Kirwan, Maria Ina Arnone *Frontiers in Ecology and Evolution, 2025* www.frontiersin.org/journals/ecology-and-evolution/articles/10.3389/fevo.2025.1548208/full

A Model of Decentralized Vision in the Sea Urchin *Diadema africanum* Tianshu Li, John D. Kirwan, Maria Ina Arnone, Dan-Eric Nilsson, Giancarlo La Camera *iScience, 2023* www.cell.com/iscience/fulltext/S2589-0042(23)00372-3